[INCH-POUND]
A-A-1519A
April 27, 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1519
April 2, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CASE, DISPATCH (Artificial Leather)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in lieu of Federal Specification KK-C-00115.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This commercial item description describes a dispatch (attache) case of artificial leather construction.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The documents referenced in this commercial item description shall be the issues in effect on the date of the invitation for bids or request for proposal unless otherwise specified. These documents form a part of this commercial item description to the extent specified. In the event that there is a conflict between this commercial item description and a document referenced herein, this commercial item description shall take precedence.

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-376 - Preferred Metric Units For General Use By The Federal Government.

Copies of Federal specifications and standards are available from the General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, General Engineering Group (7FXEG), 819 Taylor St., Fort Worth, TX 76102

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8460

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Copies of military specifications and standards may be obtained from Military Specifications and Standards, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Case construction. The dispatch case shall be constructed from supported artificial leather and shall have the following dimensions:

Length	17 5/8 +/- 3/8 inches
Height	12 3/4 +/- 3/8 inches
Depth	3 7/8 +/- 7/16 inches

The case shall be dark brown in color. The case shall be covered with a printed expanded vinyl with a minimum thickness of 0.030 inch. The print may be either single or two tone. All exterior stitching shall be functional and either brown or black, consistently. The interior stitching shall match the color of the interior lining.

The case frame shall be made from wood or chipboard with a minimum thickness of 1/4 inch and shall be of a full or partial tongue and groove or overlapping construction where the lid of the top section meets the lower tray. The interior shall have a collar of a minimum height of 1/8 inch above the top edge of the bottom section to form the overlapping construction. The corners of the frame shall be firmly joined together with a dovetail or similar joint and glued with a waterproof adhesive.

The top (lid) and bottom of the case shall be made of rigid chipboard or plywood not less than 0.100 inch in thickness with all edges beveled and securely bonded to the frame. A synthetic cushioning material of 0.020 minimum thickness shall be placed between the cover material and the chipboard or plywood on the top and bottom of the case.

3.2 Interior. The interior of the case shall be lined with artificial leather of a color harmonious with the case shells. The apron which covers the hinged area of the interior shall be covered with a vinyl of minimum thickness 0.030 inch and shall match either the exterior or interior in color. All raw perimeters of the lining shall be either bound with material and lock stitched or concealed within the frame to provide a neat and precise appearance. The attachment of the lining to the shells shall be by direct thermobonding, or by adhesive. The lining shall be securely bonded, lie smoothly in the case, and be free of wrinkles and bubbles.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The interior of the lid shall have a file pocket with a minimum of two tiered full-size compartments, one exterior compartment and two adjustable retaining straps. Each full-size compartment shall open to a minimum of 14 1/2 inches by 9 inches with the retaining straps attached. The front of the file pocket shall have a minimum of one exterior pocket for small accessories, a business card pocket and two pen loops. The file pocket shall be covered with the same material as the interior of the case or material of greater weight matching the interior.

3.3 Hardware. The case shall have a steel reinforced handle covered with the same vinyl used for the exterior of the case. The handle shall be comfortable in use and shall not expose the user to any sharp edges or points that may cause discomfort.

Hardware shall consist of the following as a minimum:

2	Exterior hinges
2	Interior hinges or stays (ball or positive stop-type to hold the lid in the open position)
4	Feet or bumpers, metal (may be integral part of hinge)
2	Latches/hasps with a combination lock on each latch

The finish on the hardware shall be brass plating. The hinges and latches/hasps shall be securely fastened to the case through the frame. The combination locks shall be capable of being reset to different combinations.

3.4 Test requirements. The case shall be capable of passing the drop test and remain fully functional. The case shall be capable of passing the handle test without loosening or deformation of the handle and supporting hardware (see 4.6 and 4.7).

3.5 Commercial item. The use of the term "commercial item description" in this document does not imply that any item or items offered are not required to conform with all requirements specified herein.

Additional or better features, which are not specifically prohibited by this purchase description but are a part of the manufacturer's standard commercial product, shall be included in the case being furnished.

3.6 Workmanship. The completed case shall present a neat, finished appearance both inside and outside, and shall exhibit no evidence of sharp, jagged, or rough frame crimping or other unfinished components. The case shall be free from defects which may affect durability, serviceability, or appearance.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7 Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable. The term "recovered materials" means materials which have been collected or recovered from solid waste and reprocessed to become a source of raw materials as opposed to virgin raw materials. None of the above shall be interpreted to mean that the use of used or rebuilt products are allowed under this commercial item description unless otherwise specified.

3.8 Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch/pound units, provided they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this commercial item description are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this purchase description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards.

4.2 Sampling. Finished cases shall be sampled and inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-105 for conformance to the construction, dimensions and testing requirements herein. A lot shall be all cases submitted for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated case.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Visual inspection. The brief cases shall be examined for defects in color, material and workmanship in accordance with Table I. The inspection level shall be II with an AQL of 2.5 defects per hundred units for major defects and 6.5 defects per hundred units for total defects.

TABLE I. Visual examination.

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Case material	Color not as specified.	X	
	Color not uniform, affecting appearance		X
Quality of case material (lining and exterior	Any hole, cut or rupture.	X	
	Any of the following imperfections: Uncoated, thinly coated, separation of coating (including at stitched edges), cracked coating, blisters, wrinkles, indistinct grain, and tackiness of artificial leather and lining.		X
Metal components	Rivets not securely set or clinched to a degree where the component may become detached.	X	
	Lock catches do not function properly.	X	
	Lock does not function properly	X	
Construction and Workmanship	Any component part or required operation omitted.	X	
	Any part fractured, ripped, torn punctured, malformed or otherwise damaged affecting serviceability.	X	
	Any component misplaced or assembly malformed affecting serviceability.	X	
Seams and stitching	Loose stitch tension resulting in a loosely secured seam.	X	
	Open seam.	X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I, continued

Seams and stitching (cont.)	More than three continuous stitch locks exposed on surface of body material, but seam is tight.		X
	More than two continuous needle holes visible as a result of removal of threads.		X
	Thread ends not trimmed.		X

Note: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs occur.

4.4 Sampling for tests. A random sample of dispatch cases shall be selected from each lot in accordance with inspection level S-2, AQL 6.5 expressed in percent defective.

4.5 Test certification. When specified, a certification of conformance to the required tests shall be acceptable in lieu of lot by lot testing. The contractor shall have available for review evidence that the specified tests have been performed within the last year, that the product tested conforms with the requirements of this commercial item description, and that the product being offered has been manufactured using the same materials, processes, and manufacturing techniques, and is otherwise identical to the product tested.

4.6 Handle test. Hang or place the case in an upside down position so that the handle will face the floor and swing freely. Attach a 75 pound (plus or minus 3 pounds) weight directly to the handle of the case, evenly distributed over the length of the handle and leave suspended for 30 minutes. Remove the weight and check attachment of handle to the case for loosening or pull-through of rivets or other attaching hardware. At completion the handle shall remain securely fastened to the case and shall not be deformed.

4.7 Drop test. Three cases from each sample lot shall be subjected to the drop test. Any failure of this test shall be grounds for rejection. An assembled case shall be filled with pillows or bags, loaded with sand or vermiculite or some similar substances, to attain the test loads and, at the same time, completely fill the interior of the case to avoid secondary impact due to shifting of the test load. The net load for the case shall be a minimum of 10.0 pounds.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The weight shall be evenly distributed and the case shall be closed and locked during the test. Each weighted case shall then be dropped 15 times to a concrete floor from a height of 24 inches (plus or minus Ø.5 inches) measured from the lowest point; 5 times so that it lands on its feet or bottom bumpers, 5 times so that it lands on one side end and 5 times so that it lands on the opposing side end. Upon completion of the test, the case shall be examined to insure that none of the components are cracked, fractured, perforated, loosened or deformed to the extent that the case is inoperable. After performance of the test, the case shall be fully functional. Cosmetic imperfections, resulting from the drops, shall not be considered defects.

4.8 Examination for preparation for delivery. A random sample of unit, intermediate and shipping containers (as applicable) shall be selected from each lot and examined for conformance with the preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking required in the contract or order. Samples shall be selected in accordance with MIL-STD-1Ø5, Inspection level S-2, AQL 6.5 expressed in terms of defects per hundred unit.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of the commercial item description
(b) Whether test certification is allowed in lieu of testing
(c) If Bid Samples are required
(d) Packaging, packing and marking required

6.2 National Stock Number (NSN). The following NSN has been assigned with this CID. Other NSNs may cite this CID as a reference document.

8460-ØØ-847-48Ø2

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Review Activities:

Air Force - 82

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:14Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.